

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Impress Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter 9 **Slideshows**

Transitions, animations, and more

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Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

Windows/Linux	Mac equivalent	Effect
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

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Creating a Slideshow

OpenOffice Impress gives you the tools to organize and display a slideshow, including:

- Which slides to show, and in what sequence
- Whether to run the show automatically or manually
- Transitions between slides
- Animations on individual slides
- Interactions: what happens when you click a button or link

Most tasks associated with creating a slideshow are best done in Slide Sorter view. Choose **View > Slide Sorter** from the menu bar or click the Slide Sorter tab at the top of the workspace. All of your slides appear in the workspace; you may need to scroll to see them all.

Choosing Basic Settings for a Slideshow

Basic settings for a slideshow include the slide to start from, the method of advancing slides, the type of presentation, and pointer options.

Choose **Slide Show > Slide Show Settings**. The Slide Show dialog appears (Figure 1).

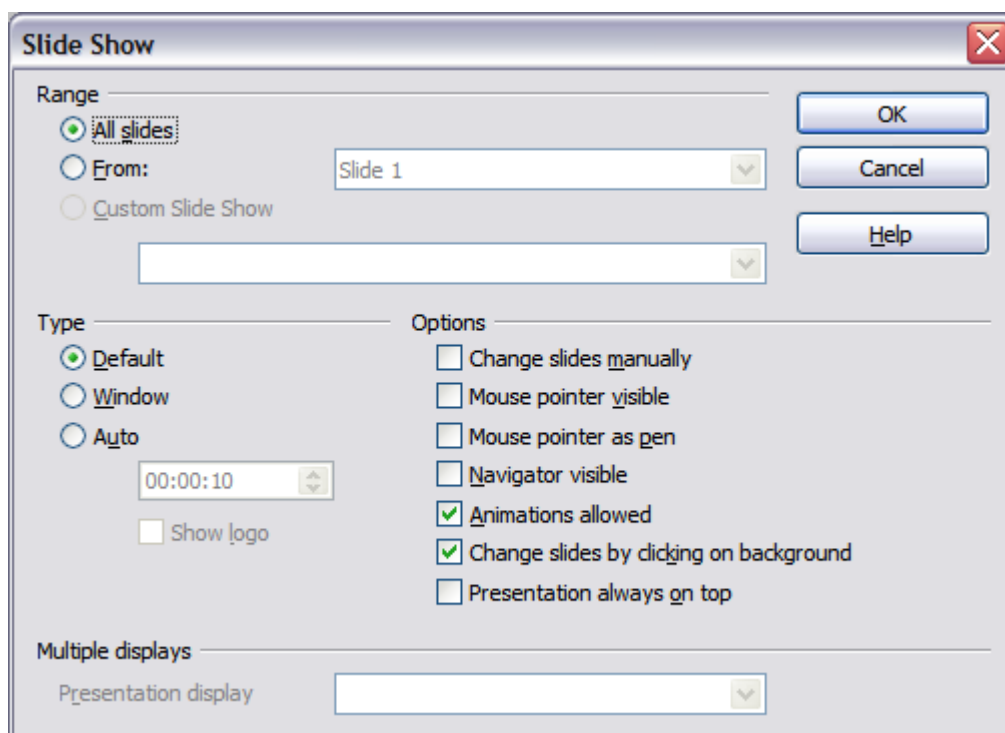


Figure 1: Choosing slideshow settings

In the *Range* section, choose which slides to include in the slideshow:

- **All slides** includes all of the slides except for those marked Hidden (see “Hiding Slides” on page 6). Slides are shown in the sequence in which they occur in the file. To change the sequence, either rearrange the slides in the slide sorter or choose a custom slide show (see below).
- **From:** starts the show at a slide other than the first. For example, you might have several slides at the beginning that describe you and your company, but

when you present this show to your work colleagues, you want to skip that introduction.

- **Custom Slide Show** shows the slides in a different sequence than you have previously set up. This choice is not available until after you set up a custom slideshow (see “Showing Slides in a Different Order” on page 6). You can set up as many custom shows as you wish from a single set of slides; they will appear in the drop-down list under this choice.

In the *Type* section, choose how the slides will be displayed:

- **Default** shows the slides full screen, without the OpenOffice program controls visible, and exits the show after the last slide.
- **Window** runs the slideshow in the OpenOffice program window and exits the show after the last slide.
- **Auto** restarts the slideshow after the last slide. A pause slide is displayed between the last slide and the start slide. Press the *Esc* key to stop the show. In the box under this choice, specify the length of time before the show restarts. If you enter zero, the show restarts immediately without showing a pause slide. This setting does not control how slides advance within the presentation. See the section Using Slide Transitions for those settings. The **Show Logo** option shows the OpenOffice logo on the pause slide.

In the *Options* section:

- **Change slides manually** prevents slides from changing automatically, even if an automatic transition has been set up.
- **Mouse pointer visible** shows the mouse pointer during a slideshow. If you do not have a laser pointer or other device to highlight items of interest during the show, this can be quite useful.
- **Mouse pointer as pen** enables you to write or draw on slides during the presentation. Anything you write with the pen is not saved when you exit the slideshow. The availability of the pen, its color, and its width can be conveniently controlled by right-clicking on a slide during the slideshow.
- **Navigator visible** displays the Navigator during the slideshow. For more about the Navigator, see Chapter 1 (Introducing Impress).
- **Animations allowed** displays all frames of animated GIF files during the slideshow. If this option is not selected, only the first frame of an animated GIF file is displayed. (This has nothing to do with the slide animations described in “Using Slide Animation Effects” on page 10.)
- **Change slides by clicking on background** advances to the next slide when you click on the background of a slide. Other ways of advancing to the next slide include pressing the spacebar on the keyboard.
- **Presentation always on top** prevents any other program window from appearing on top of the presentation.

In the *Multiple displays* section, you can choose which display to use for full-screen slideshow mode if the current desktop is displayed on more than one monitor. If the current desktop spans only one monitor, or if the multiple-display feature is not supported on the current system, you cannot select another display. By default, the primary display is used for slideshow mode.

Note

This multi-displays setting is not a property saved in the document, but is instead saved as a local setting in the user configuration. This means that if you open the presentation on a different computer, the local settings, that is, the settings on that different computer, are applied.

Hiding Slides

You may not want to show all of the slides in a particular show. You can either hide some of the slides or set up a custom slideshow; which method is best depends on your needs. For example, you may have draft slides that you do not want to show until they are finished, or you may have some slides that contain information for yourself, but not your audience.

To hide a slide:

- 1) In the Slides pane, or in Slide Sorter view, select the slides that you want to hide.
- 2) Click the **Hide Slide** icon on the Slide View toolbar, or right-click and select **Hide Slide** from the context menu, or choose **Slide Show > Hide Slide**. The slide is now shown with diagonal lines through it, indicating that it is hidden (Figure 2). The slide remains in the file.

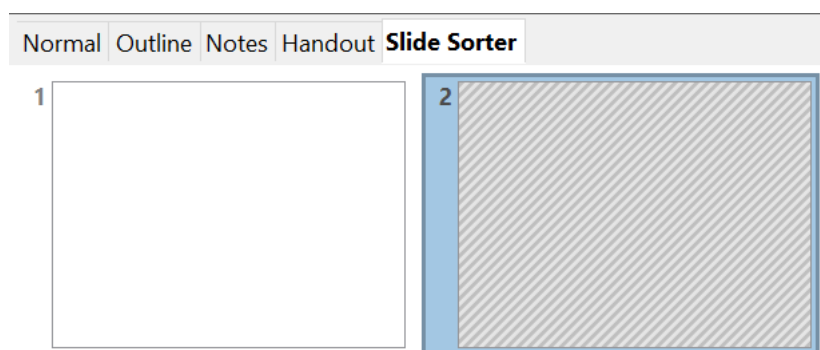


Figure 2: Slide 2 is hidden

To show a hidden slide:

- 1) In the Slides pane, or in Slide Sorter view, select the hidden slides that you want to show.
- 2) Click the **Show Slide** icon on the Slide View toolbar, or right-click and select **Show Slide** from the context menu, or choose **Slide Show > Show Slide**.

Showing Slides in a Different Order

To show the slides in a different order, you can either rearrange them in the slide sorter or set up a custom slideshow. You can define as many custom slideshows as you need from one set of slides. In a custom slideshow, you can choose which slides to include as well as the order in which they are shown. Any slides marked *Hidden* will not appear in a custom show.

Setting up a Custom Slideshow

To set up a new custom slideshow:

- 1) Choose **Slide Show > Custom Slide Show** from the menu bar.
- 2) On the Custom Slide Shows dialog (Figure 3), click **New**.

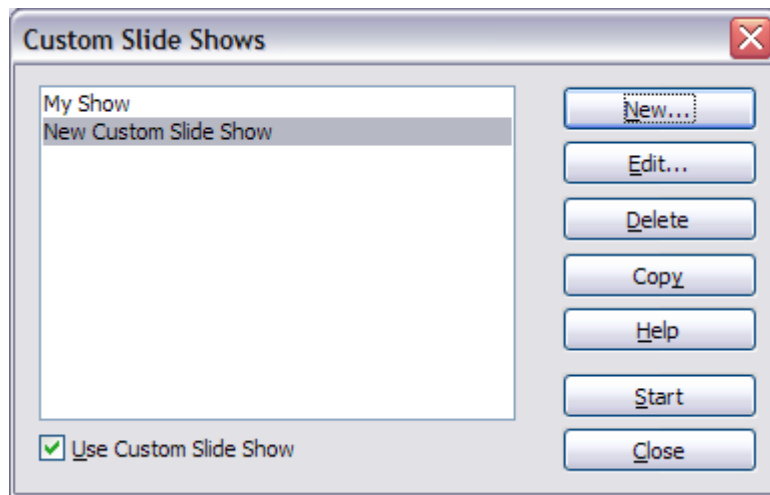


Figure 3: Start here to define or change a custom slideshow

- 3) On the Define Custom Slide Show dialog, type a name for the new custom show. Then, in the *Existing slides* list, select the slides to include in the show, **in the order you want to show them**. Click the $\geq$ button to include the slides in the *Selected slides* list. In Figure 4, Title Slide and Slide 4 have been included; Slide 2 has been selected but not yet included.

You can select and include several slides at the same time. Hold down the *Shift* key and click the first and last slide in a group to select that group (for example, slides 3 through 7), or hold down the *Control* key and click on individual slides to select them (for example, slides 3, 5, and 9).

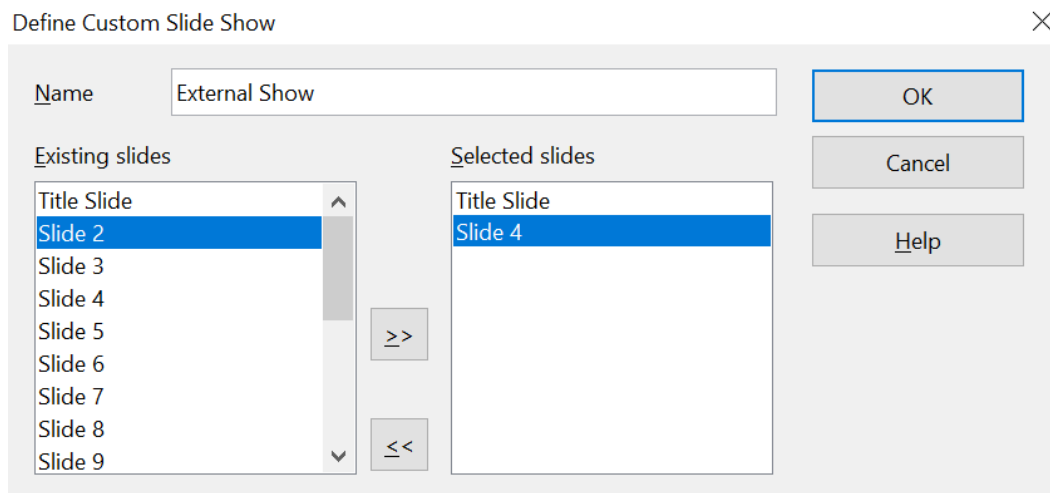


Figure 4: Defining a custom slideshow

- 4) When you have finished arranging the order of the slides, click **OK** to save this custom show and return to the Custom Slide Shows dialog. To activate your custom show, select the **Use Custom Slide Show** option at the bottom.

Note

If you include several slides at the same time, they are added to the *Selected slides* list in numerical order, regardless of the order in which you selected them. In other words, if you click on slides 3, 9, and 5 in that order, and add them all at the same time, they will be included in the *Selected slides* list in this order: 3, 5, 9. To rearrange them, either select and include them one at a time or select and drag them up or down the list. You can also use the Slide Sorter view to rearrange the order of slides.

Tip

Slides are added to the *Selected slides* list after whichever slide is currently highlighted in that list. The last slide added is highlighted unless you select a different one. For example, you may have added slides 1, 2, 3, and 9, in that order. Slide 9 will be highlighted. If you now want to add slide 15 between slides 2 and 3, select slide 2 in the *Selected slides* list, then select slide 15 in the *Existing slides* list and click $\geq>$.

You can also add slide 15 to the end of the *Selected slides* list and then drag it up to where you want it in the sequence.

Editing, Deleting, or Copying a Custom Slideshow

To edit a custom slideshow (add, remove, or change the order of slides, or change the name of the show), select it in the Custom Slide Shows dialog (Figure 3) and click **Edit**.

To delete a custom slideshow, select it in the Custom Slide Shows dialog and click **Delete**. Deletion is immediate; no confirmation message appears.

To create a copy of a slideshow, select it in the Custom Slide Shows dialog and click **Copy**. You can now edit the copy to rename it, add to, remove from, or change the order of slides within it.

You can run a custom slideshow (for example, to test it) from the Custom Slide Shows dialog if the **Use Custom Slide Show** checkbox is selected. Select the slideshow from the list and click **Start**.

When you have finished working with custom slide shows, click **Close** to save all changes and close the Custom Slide Shows dialog.

Using Slide Transitions

Slide transitions are the effects that occur when one slide gives way to the next in a presentation, like *Roll down from top* or *Fly in from left*. They add dynamic flair to a slideshow, smoothing the transition between slides.

- 1) In the Sidebar, choose the **Slide Transition** deck (Figure 5)
- 2) In the Slides pane or Slide Sorter view, select the slides to which you want to apply the transition. If you want the transition to apply to all slides, you do not need to select them first.
- 3) In the **Apply to selected slides** list, select a transition.

- 4) Modify the selected transition by changing the speed or adding a sound in the Modify transition area. If you choose to play a sound, select it in the **Sound** list. The **Loop until next sound** option now becomes active. Select this option to play the sound repeatedly until another sound starts. If you select this option and there are no subsequent sounds in your slideshow, the sound will play continuously for the remainder of the show.
- 5) Next, choose how to advance to the next slide: manually (on mouse click) or automatically. If you choose automatically, you can specify how long the slide remains visible before it automatically advances to the next slide.
- 6) To apply the transition to all slides, click the **Apply to All Slides** button.

To start the slideshow from the current slide (so you can see all the transitions), click the **Slide Show** button.

If the **Automatic preview** checkbox is marked, the effect of a selected transition is immediately displayed in the work area. You can replay the effect at any time by pressing the **Play** button.

You can apply a single type of transition to all slides in the presentation, or apply a different transition to any single slide. You can even have a different transition for every slide in the show. But be careful. While trying many different transitions may be fun, it might give your show an unprofessional appearance.

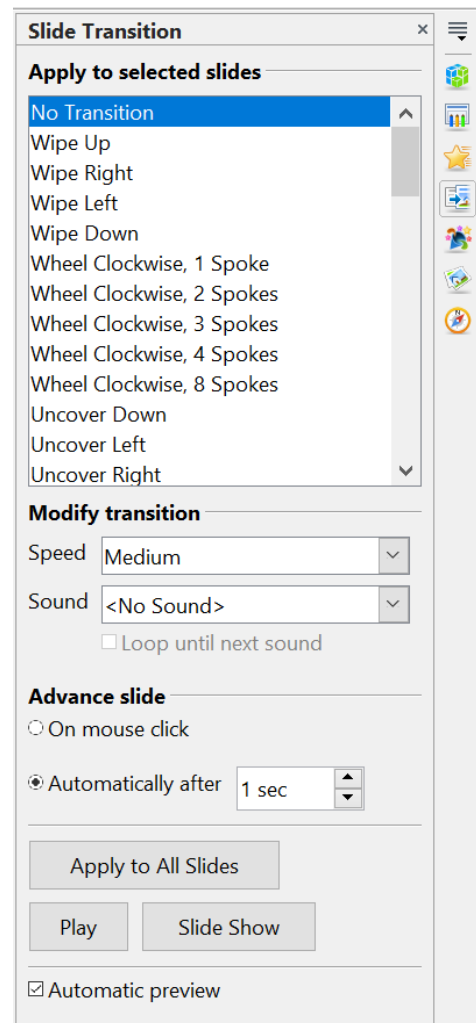


Figure 5: Slide Transition deck of the Sidebar

Tip

If you want most of your slides to have the same transition, but a few to be different, you may find it easier to apply one transition to all slides, and then change only the ones you want to make unique.

Setting the Timing of Automatic Slide Changes

You can set up a slideshow to run automatically, either unattended or while you speak. To set the default time for slides to be displayed before changing to the next slide, go to the Slide Transition deck of the Sidebar (Figure 5), leave the transition effect set to No Transition, choose **Automatically after** in the *Advance slide* section, set a time, and click the **Apply to All Slides** button.

To vary the timing for some slides, choose **Slide Show > Rehearse Timings** from the menu bar, or click the **Rehearse Timings** icon on the Slide Show toolbar. The slideshow begins in full-screen mode, and a timer appears in the lower-left corner of the screen.

When you want to advance to the next slide, click the timer and then advance the slide manually with the *Enter* key. To keep the default setting for this slide, click the slide, not the timer. Continue for all slides in your presentation. Impress records the display time for each slide. When you next look at the time set under **Automatically after**, you will see that the times have changed to match what you set when rehearsing.

If you want the whole presentation to auto-repeat, open the menu **Slide Show > Slide Show Settings**. Click **Auto** and **OK**.

Playing a Sound Throughout the Presentation

You can use the Slide Transition pane to set up Impress so that your chosen sound is played throughout the presentation. To do that:

- 1) Select the slide where you want the sound to start and go to the Slide Transition pane.
- 2) In the *Modify transition* section, select the entry **Other sound** from the Sound drop-down menu and choose a sound file.
- 3) Select the **Loop until next sound** checkbox if you want the sound to restart once it is finished.

Caution



Do not click the **Apply to all** button. Doing so would cause your selected sound to restart at every slide.

Note

The sound file is linked to the presentation rather than embedded. If you plan to display the presentation on a different machine, you must also make the sound file available on the machine where the presentation will be played and re-establish the link to the local sound file before starting the slideshow.

Removing a Transition Effect

- 1) Select the desired slides.
- 2) Choose **No Transition** in the list on the *Slide Transition* deck of the Sidebar.

Using Slide Animation Effects

Slide animations are similar to transitions, but they are applied to individual elements on a single slide—a title, chart, shape, or individual bullet point. Animations can make a presentation more lively and memorable. Just as with transitions, the heavy use of animations can be fun, but also distracting and even annoying for an audience expecting a professional presentation.

Animation effects need to be applied from Normal view so that you can select individual objects on a single slide.

Note

At present, it is not possible to apply animation effects to the slide master elements. This means that if you want to display the items in a text box one by one, you need to apply the effects to each text box, or alternatively, copy the text box from one slide to another.

Applying an Animation Effect

In Normal view, display the desired slide. Select the text or object you want to animate. An object, such as a graphic or an entire text box, will have green handles around it when selected. If you choose only a portion of the text in a text box, you may not see any green handles.

In the Sidebar, choose the **Custom Animation** deck(Figure 6).

Click **Add**. The Custom Animation dialog (Figure 7) appears. Choose an effect from one of the tabs of this dialog, and choose the speed or duration of that effect. See the example on page 12 for some hints on how to combine multiple effects.

To choose the animation to be applied when the object is placed on the screen, use an effect from the *Entrance* page, for example, *Fly In* or *Dissolve In*.

Use the *Emphasis* page to apply a basic effect, such as changing the font color, or to add special effects such as blinking text.

To choose the effect to be applied when the object is leaving the screen, use the *Exit* page.

If you want the object to move along a line or curve, select an animation from the *Motion Paths* page. An example of this type of animation is provided in “Example: Setting up a Motion Path” on page 16.

Click **OK** to save the effect and return to the *Custom Animation* deck of the Sidebar. Here you can choose how to start the animation, change the speed, and apply additional properties to the selected effect.

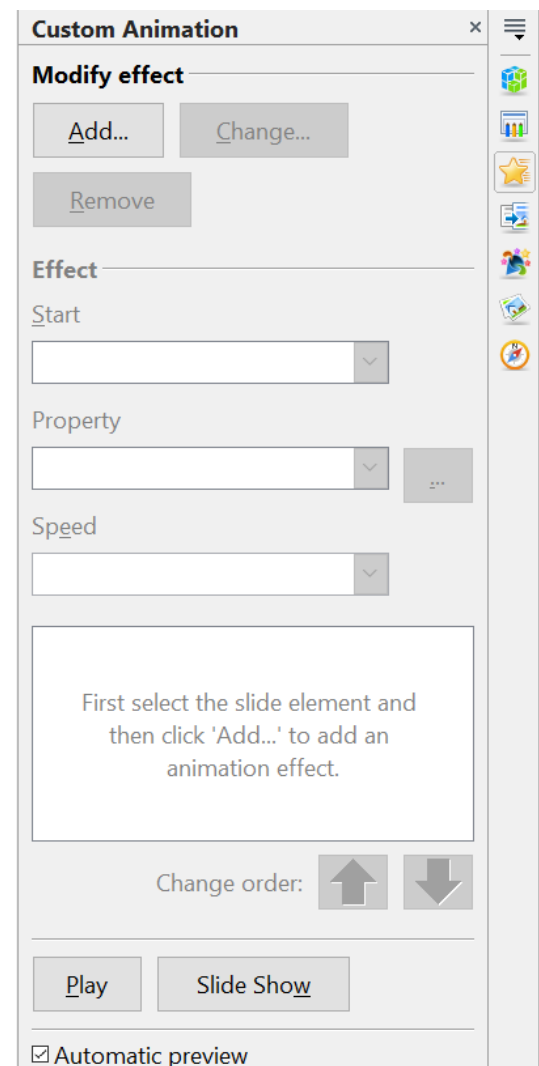


Figure 6: Task pane, showing Custom Animation page

Starting an Animation Effect

You have three choices for starting an animation effect:

On click — The animation does not start until you click the mouse.

With previous — The animation runs at the same time as the previous animation.
After previous — The animation runs as soon as the previous animation ends.

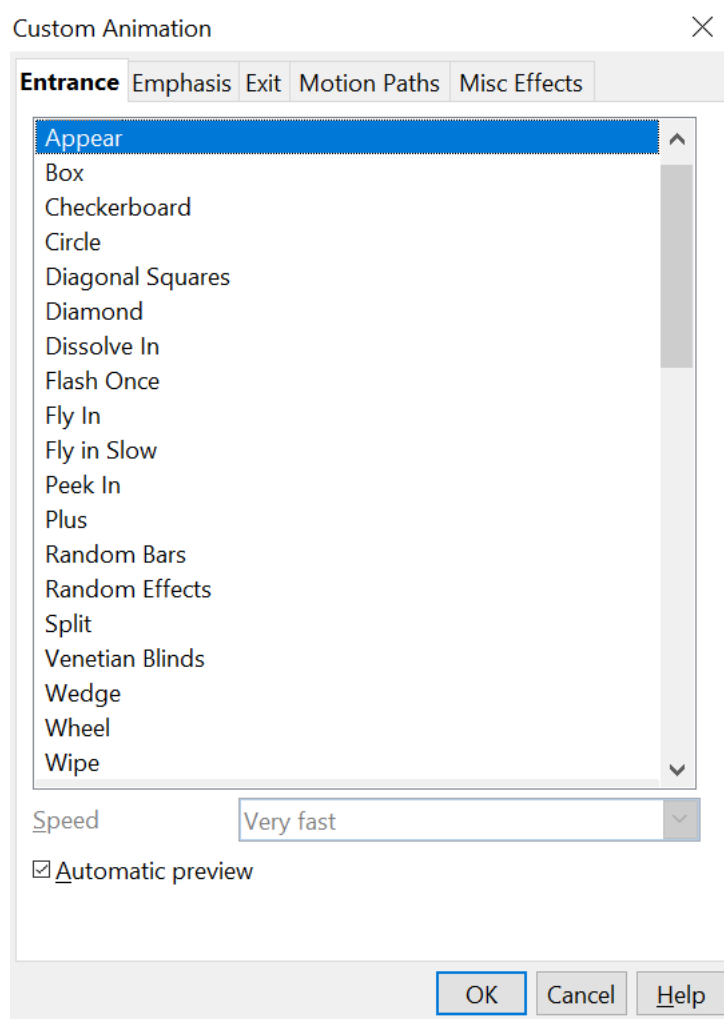


Figure 7: Custom Animation dialog. Choices may vary depending on the selected object; for example, pictures and text have different Emphasis choices.

Choosing Additional Properties of an Animation Effect

Many animations have properties that you can set or change. For example, if you choose the Change Font Color effect on the *Emphasis* page, you can specify the font color. If you choose Fly In on the *Entrance* page, you can specify the direction from which the object flies in.

The label on the properties box changes depending on the choices available for each effect. For example, a Fly In effect has a box labeled *Direction*, and a Change Font Color effect has a box labeled *Font color*.

Example: Using Multiple Animation Effects

To illustrate how you can set up multiple effects, let's look at a common animation: list items fly in one at a time from the bottom of the slide, and as each new item appears, the previous items change to a different color. Here is how to create these effects:

Step 1. Apply the “fly in” effect to individual list items.

- 1) Display the *Custom Animation* deck of the Sidebar.
- 2) Create a slide with several items in a bullet list. Our example slide (Figure 8) has four.

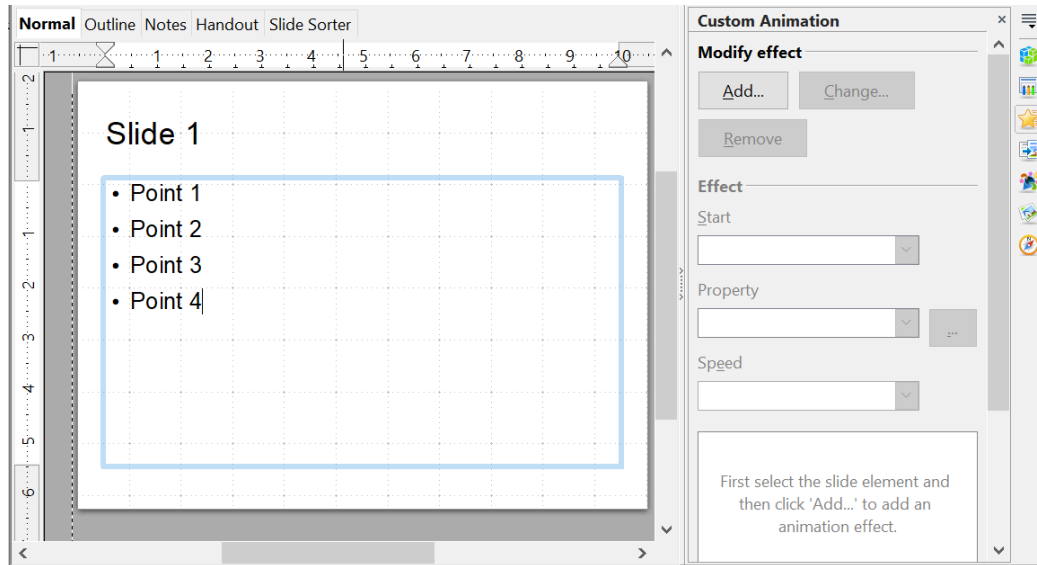


Figure 8: Example slide for multiple animations

- 3) Select all four items. Click **Add** on the Custom Animation pane.
- 4) On the *Entrance* page of the Custom Animation dialog (Figure 9), select **Fly In**, optionally change the Speed to **Medium**, and click **OK**.
- 5) The four effects you have just set up are listed in the animations list on the *Custom Animation* page, as shown in Figure 10.

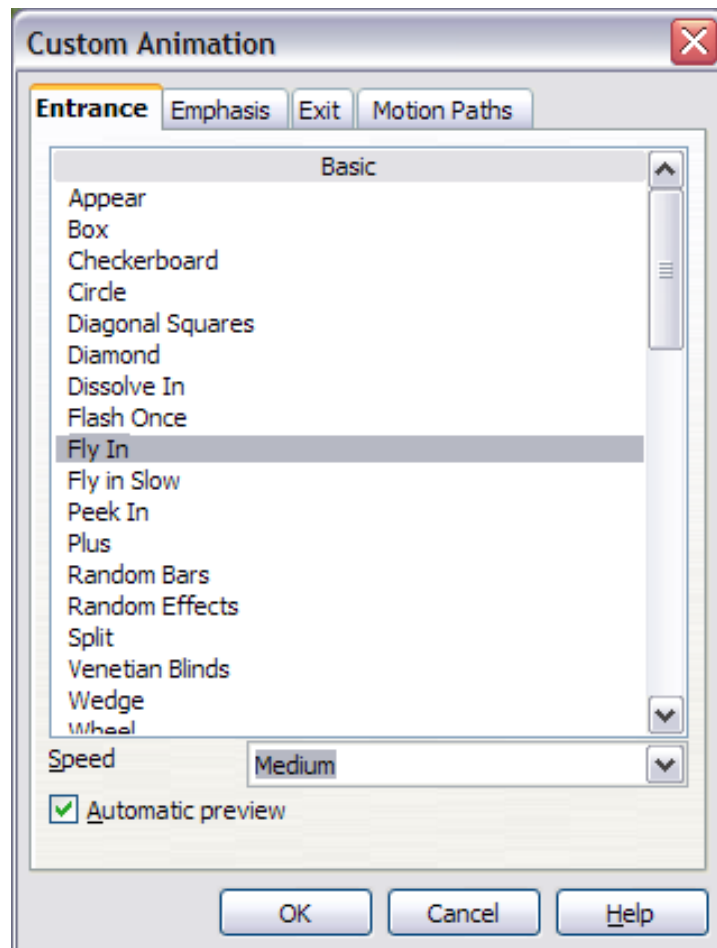


Figure 9: Choosing an entrance effect

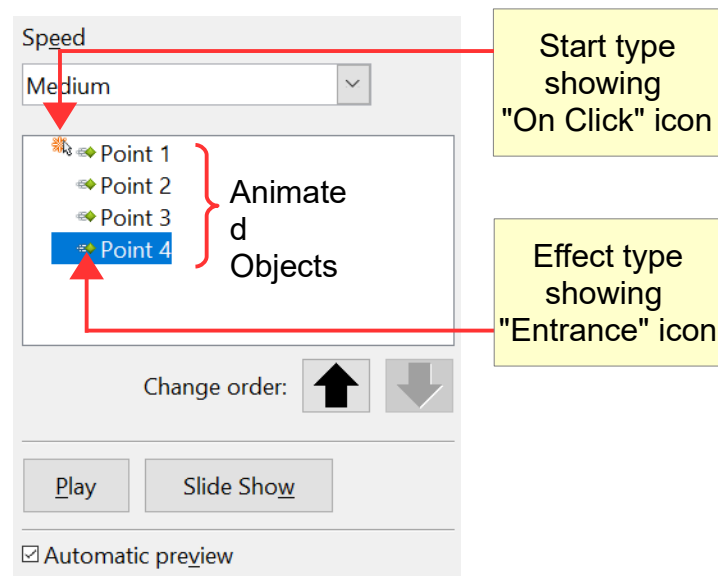


Figure 10: Animation list, showing four items

Step 2. Apply the “change font color” effect to some list items.

Now we want to set each of the first three list items to change color when the following item appears on the slide. To do this:

- 1) Select the first three items on the slide (not the animations list) and click **Add** in the Custom Animation pane. This time, we go to the *Emphasis* page of the Custom Animation dialog and choose **Change Font Color**, as shown in Figure 11. Click **OK** to save this effect.

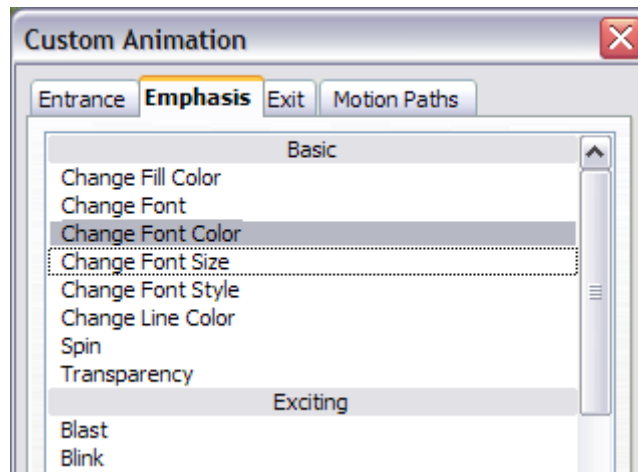


Figure 11: Choosing an emphasis effect

- 2) Notice that the three new animations are listed at the bottom of the animations list, and the “type of effect” icon for these three effects (in the second column) is different from the icon for the first four effects (see Figure 12).

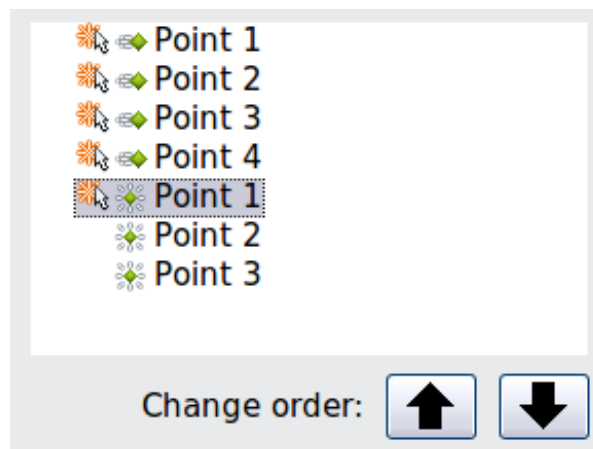


Figure 12: Animation list after adding a second set of animations

- 3) You could, if you wish, select any of the last three items and choose a different color from the *Font color* list on the Custom Animation pane.
- 4) Use the **Change order:** up-arrow button to move each of the last three items up the list to just under the other item with the same name. The animation list will now look like Figure 13.

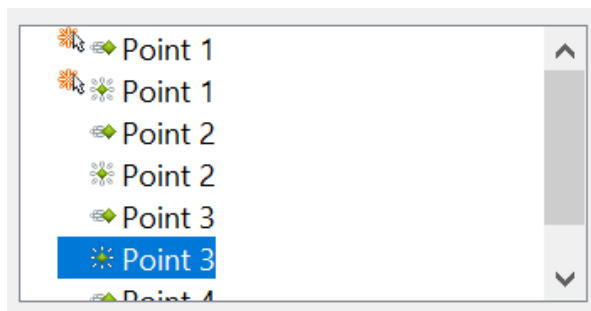


Figure 13: Animation list after moving items into required sequence

Step 3. Change the timing for some list items from **With previous** to **On click**

Notice that all of the items on the animations list (except for the two “Point one” items) are set to start at the same time as the previous item. However, it is best if, when you click to make the next point appear, the previous point is dimmed. You can set the color change of the previous point and the entrance of the new point to run on one mouse click simultaneously.

- 1) Select the color change animations for points 2 and 3 and choose **On click** from the *Start* list, then select the entrance animations (except the first) and choose **With Previous** from the *Start* list. The animation list now looks like Figure 14.
- 2) Test this set of animations by clicking the **Slide Show** button.

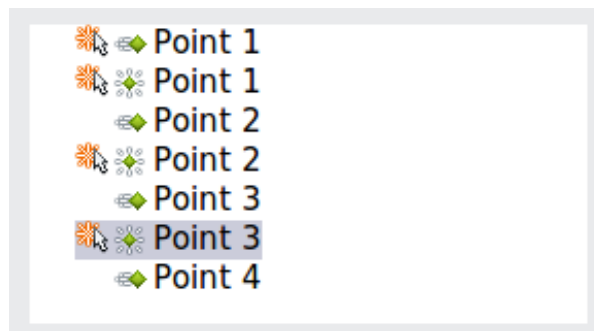


Figure 14: Final list of animations

Example: Setting up a Motion Path

The *Motion path* effect moves an object along a path that consists of a combination of straight and curved lines. Several pre-packaged paths are provided in AOO, but it is not difficult to create your own custom path. Start by selecting the object you want to animate and clicking **Add** on the Custom Animation deck of the Sidebar. Choose the *Motion Paths* tab and select a pre-packaged motion path animation that is similar to the effect you want to obtain. Alternatively, use the *Polygon* or *Curve* animation to create a new path.

Select the object to show the animation path, which will be displayed as a thin gray line with a triangle showing the starting point and another indicating the end point. Click on any point on the line so that blue handles are displayed around it. When the blue handles around the path are shown, you can move or resize the path the same way you would perform these operations on a graphic object.

Note

When moving a path, remember also to move the object on that path. Otherwise, the animation will start with a jump. Also note that currently it is not possible to rotate a path.

If instead you want to modify the individual points on the line, select the **Points** tool



from the Drawing toolbar while the path is selected. The Edit Points toolbar of Figure 15 should be displayed; if not, select it from **View > Toolbars > Edit Points**.

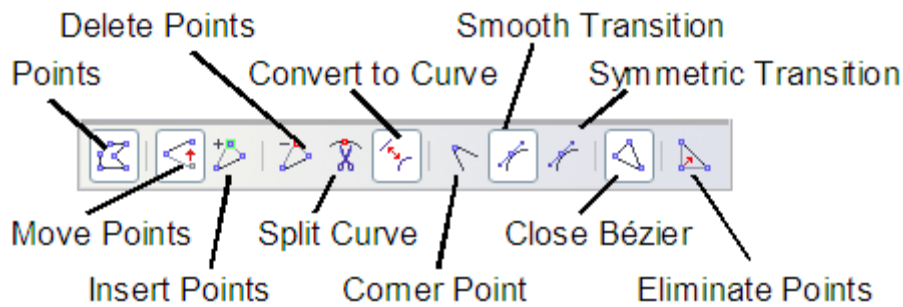


Figure 15: The Edit Points toolbar

Once a point is selected, you can add an additional point, delete it, move it, and so on. For a detailed explanation on how to manipulate the points on a curve, see the *Draw Guide*. Once you are satisfied with the shape of the curve and its speed, click anywhere on the screen to deselect the object and continue normal editing.

Figure 16 shows a polygon motion path with a curved section.

You can combine a motion with other effects, such as spinning, changing size, or colors, to create dramatic effects.

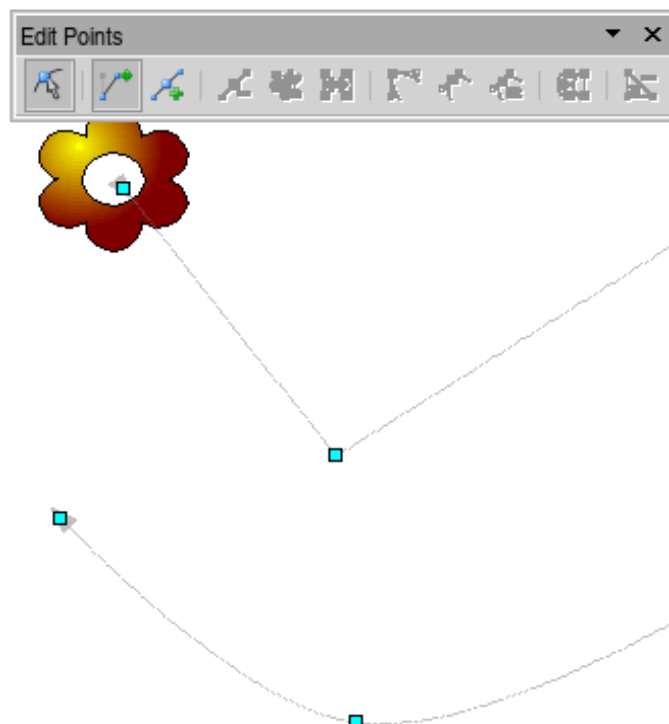


Figure 16: Object set to move along a polygon and curve path

Advanced Animation Effects

On the Custom Animation pane of the Sidebar, click the Effect Options button [...] next to the Properties drop-down list to display the Effect Options dialog.

Note

What you see in the Effect Options dialog depends on the selected animation object. For example, the dialog has three tabs for text objects but only two tabs for picture objects (the *Text Animation* tab does not appear). The Settings section on the *Effect* tab also varies. Figure 17 shows the *Effect* page for a Direction effect, and Figure 18 shows the Settings section for a Font Color effect.

On the *Effect* tab of the Effect Options dialog (Figures 17 and 18), you can choose a sound to play, whether to dim or hide the object after animation, and (in the case of text objects) whether to animate the text all at once or word by word or letter by letter.

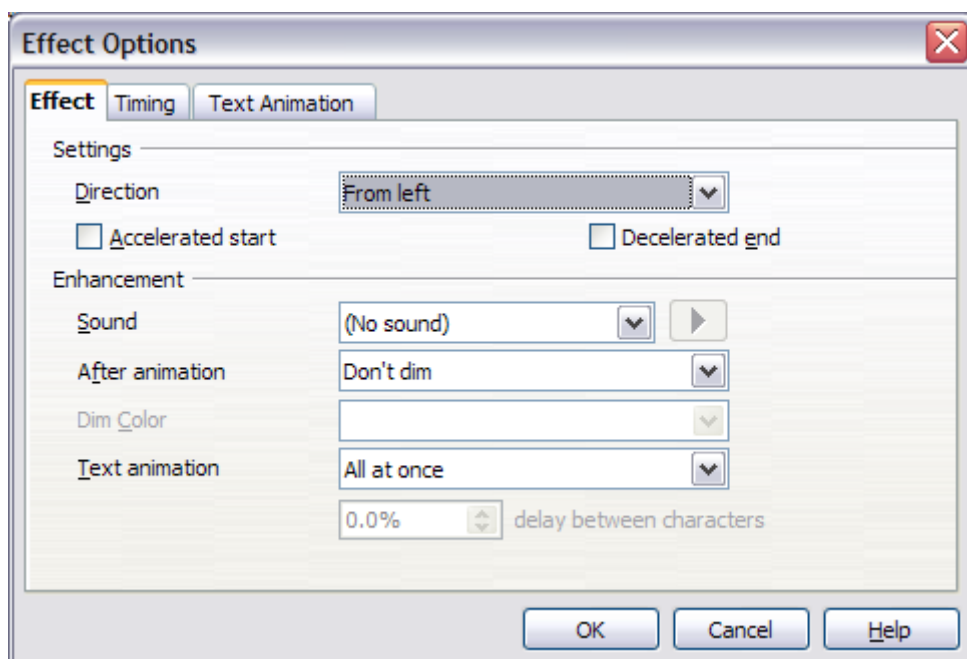


Figure 17: Effect options settings for a direction effect

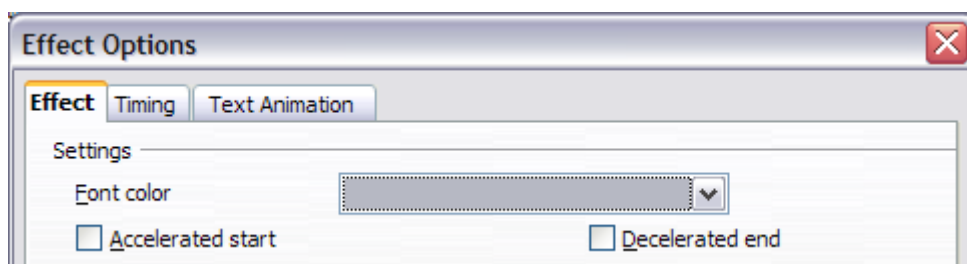


Figure 18: Effect options settings for a font color effect

On the *Text Animation* tab of the Effect Options dialog (Figure 19), you can group text in other ways: as one object, all paragraphs at once, or by first-level paragraphs (that is, one list item together with its sub-items, if any).

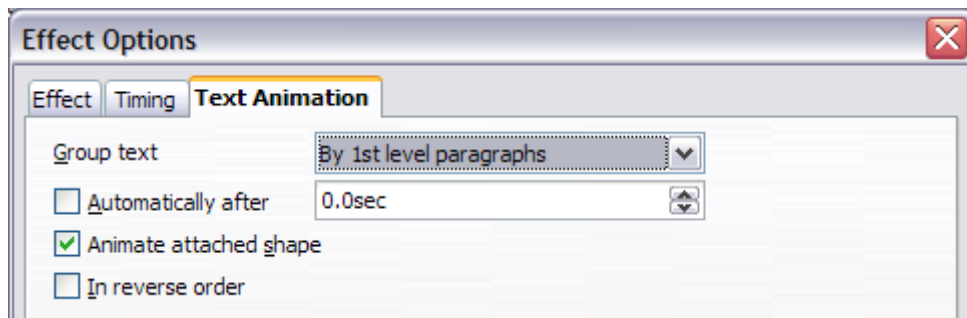


Figure 19: Text Animation effect options

The choices on the *Timing* tab of the Effect Options dialog, shown in Figure 20, allow you to change the speed, delay, and other aspects of the effect's timing.

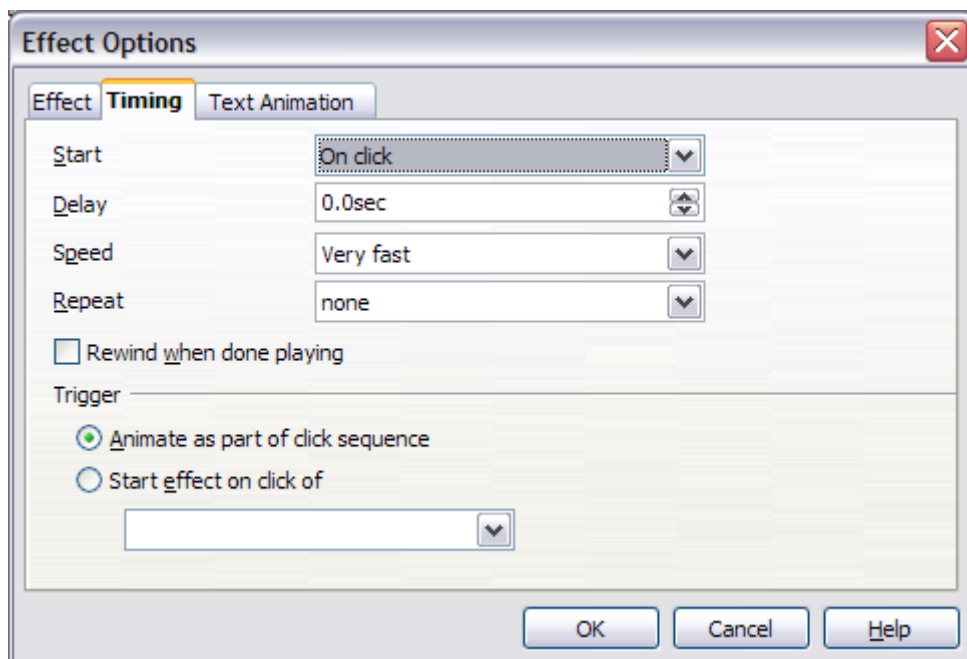


Figure 20: Timing tab of Effect Options dialog

Removing Animation Effects

- 1) On the *Custom Animation* deck of the Sidebar, select the desired object.
- 2) Click the **Remove** button.

Using Interactions

Interactions are things that happen when you click on an object in a slide. They are typically used with buttons or images, but text objects can also have interactions. Possible interactions include: go to previous slide, go to next slide, go to first slide, go to last slide, go to page or object (such as a specific slide or named object within a slide), go to document, play sound, or run a macro.

To apply an interaction to an object (or change an interaction applied to an object), right-click on the object and choose **Interaction** from the pop-up menu. The Interaction dialog (Figure 21) appears. Select an interaction from the **Action at mouse click** drop-down list.

With some interactions, after you select one, the dialog changes to offer more choices. For example, Figure 22 shows the Interaction dialog after choosing **Go to page or object**.

Tip

A sound interaction can also be applied using the Effect Options dialog (Figure 17).

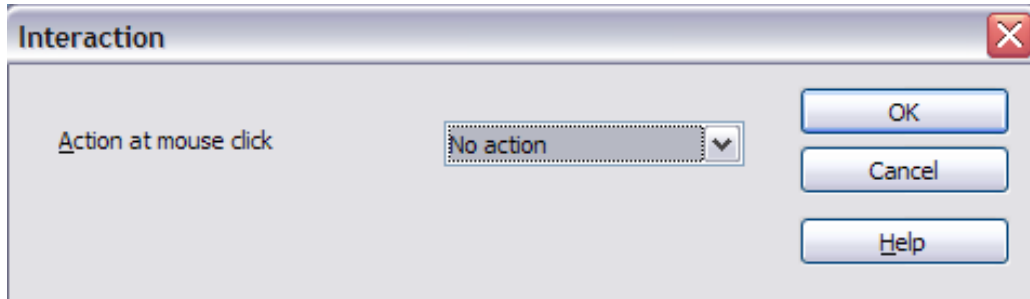


Figure 21: Dialog before choosing an interaction

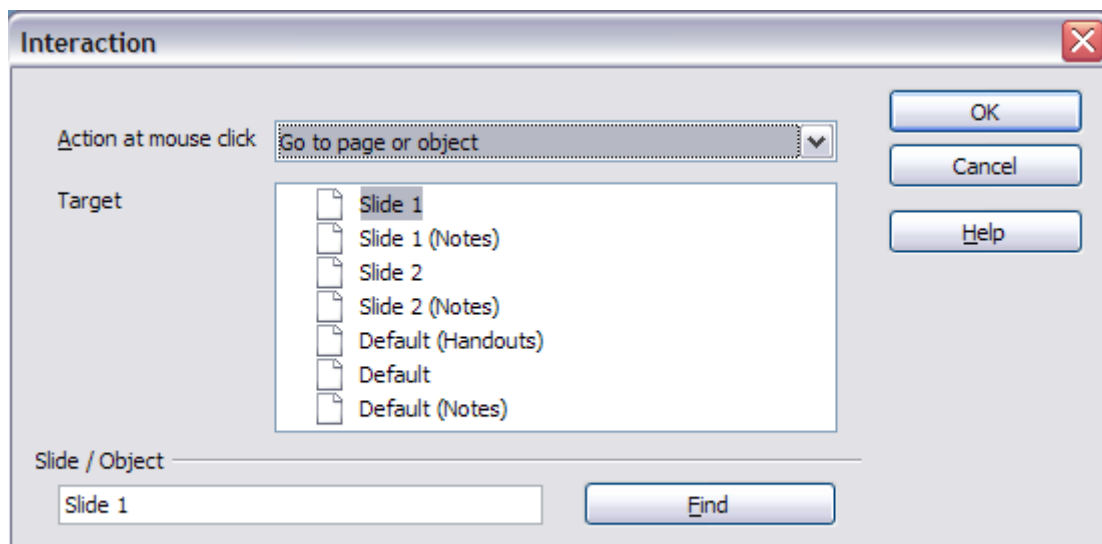


Figure 22: Dialog after choosing the “Go to page or object” interaction, showing choices for the target slide or object

Running a Slideshow

To run the slideshow, do one of the following:

- Press **F5** or **F9**.
- Click **Slide Show > Slide Show** on the main menu bar.
- Click the **Slide Show** button on the Presentation toolbar or the Slide Sorter toolbar.

If the slide transition is *Automatically after x seconds*, let the slideshow run by itself.

If the slide transition is *On mouse click*, do one of the following to advance from one slide to the next.

- Press the *down arrow* key, the *right arrow* key, or the *Page Down* key on the keyboard.

- Click the left mouse button.
- Press the *Spacebar*.

To go backwards through the show one slide at a time, press the *up arrow* key, the *left arrow* key, or the *Page Up* key. For more complex navigation, use the Presenter Screen or the right-click menu (see below).

Custom animations on a slide are run in the specified order when performing one of the above actions.

When you advance past the last slide, the message **Click to exit presentation...** appears. Click the left mouse button or press any key to exit the presentation.

To exit the slideshow and return to the Impress workspace at any time, including at the end, press the *Esc* key.

Using the Presenter Screen

If your computer supports two displays, the Presenter Screen provides several tools to help you deliver a smooth and timely presentation. To enable the Presenter Screen, choose **Tools > Options**, expand the OpenOffice Impress list on the left, click on *General*, and select the box labeled **With Presenter Screen** in the *Start Presentation* section of the dialog.

To choose which display shows the slideshow, choose **Slide Show > Slide Show Settings...** from the main menu bar (see Figure 1). In the *Multiple displays* section at the bottom of the dialog, choose the display that your audience will see.

When you start the slideshow, the display not showing the slideshow will have the Presenter Screen as shown in Figure 23.

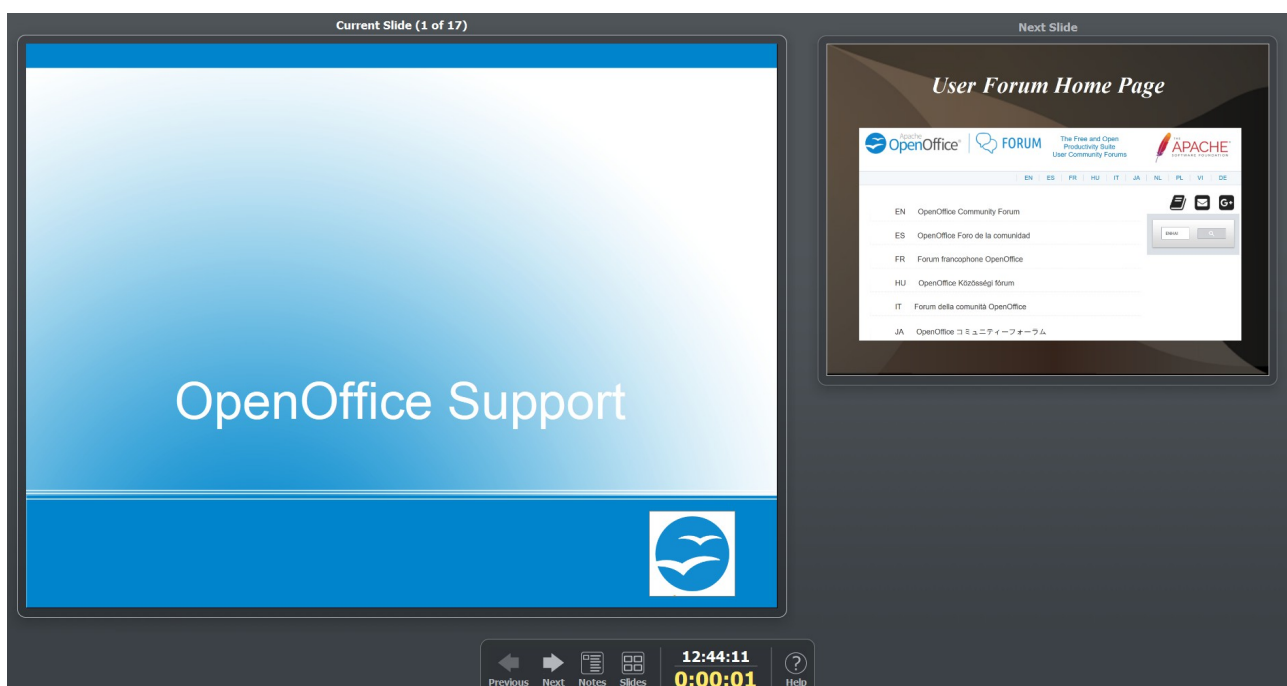


Figure 23: The Presenter Screen's default layout

The main pane on the left shows the current slide, and the pane on the right shows the next slide. The toolbar at the bottom has arrows for moving to the next or the previous slide, buttons to switch to Notes or Slides view, the current time, and the total duration of the current slideshow. Moving between slides can also be done with the keyboard, as explained in the previous section.

If you click the **Notes** button, the view changes as shown in Figure 24. The current and next slides are still displayed, but the notes attached to the current slide occupy the right side of the screen. You can return to the default view by clicking the **Close** button at the bottom of the Notes pane.

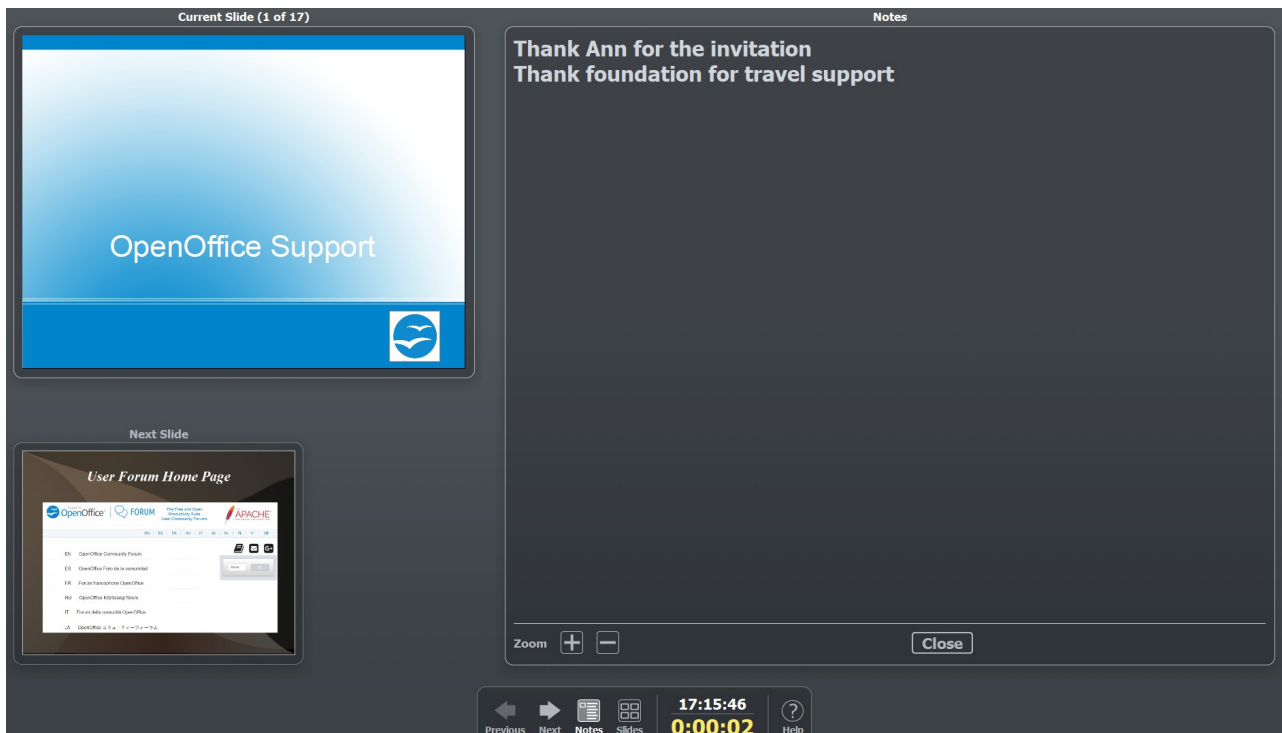


Figure 24: The Notes view of the Presenter Screen

Clicking the **Slides** button on the toolbar displays all of the slides in the presentation, as shown in Figure 25. You can quickly jump to any slide by clicking on its icon. The audience does not see the Slides view; they see a clean transition to the newly chosen slide.

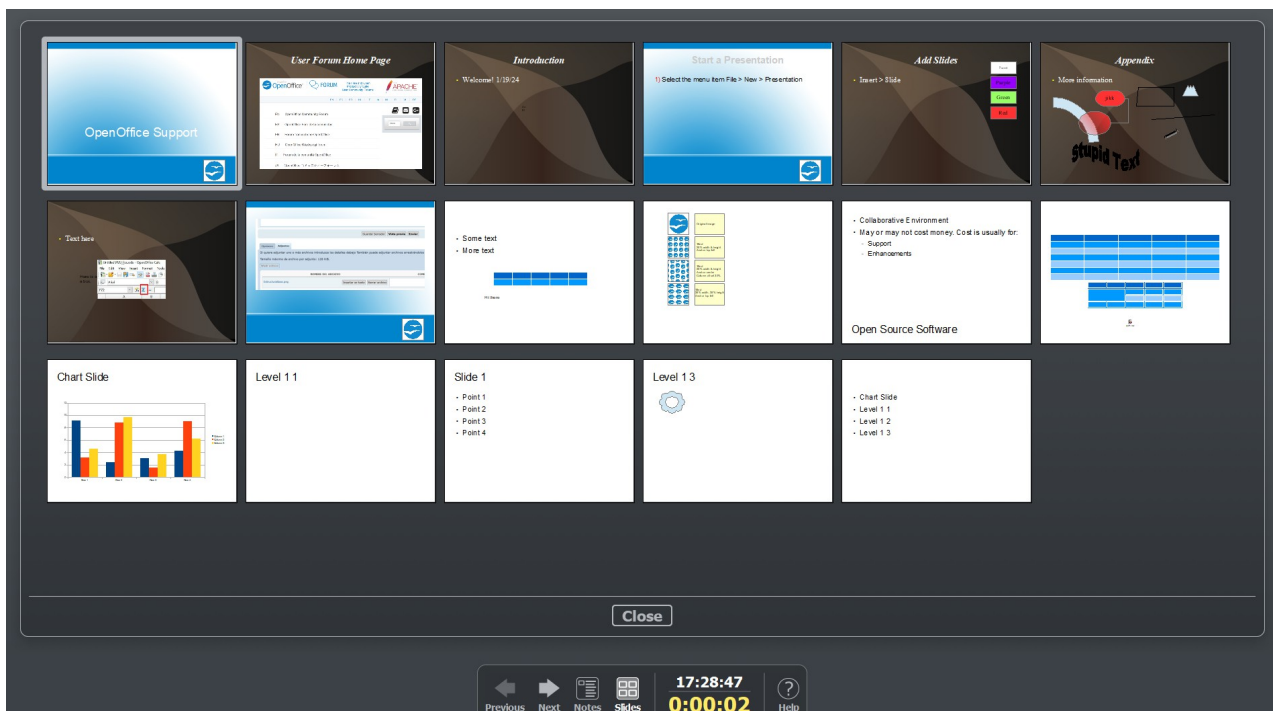


Figure 25: The Slides view of the Presenter Screen

Navigating Using the Right-click Menu

If your presentation consists of more than one slide, right-clicking anywhere on the screen brings up a menu. The choices for navigating the presentation are:

Next: Moves to the next slide in the defined sequence.

Previous: Move to the previous slide in the defined sequence.

Go to Slide: Displays a submenu allowing quick navigation through the presentation. Choices on the submenu include **First slide**, **Last Slide**, or any slide in the show. This illustrates why giving the slides meaningful names, rather than using the default Slide 1, Slide 2, and so on, can be very helpful.

Screen: Displays a submenu with two choices. Each choice blanks the screen, showing it as either all black or all white. This can be useful if you want to pause the show for a while (perhaps during a break or to demonstrate something on another computer).

End Show: Ends the presentation and returns you to the Impress workspace. This is the same effect as pressing the *Esc* key.

The context menu also has the options, *Mouse pointer as Pen*, *Pen Width (with five options)*, *Change pen Color*, *Erase all ink on Slide*.